

ABC SCHOOL
Sample Educational Institution

Teacher Handbook

Guidance for Faculty and Instructional Staff

Academic Year: 2025-2026

Edition: Sample Edition

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Table of Contents

1. Welcome and Purpose	3
2. School Mission and Teaching Philosophy	3
3. Roles and Reporting Lines	4
4. Working Hours and Duties	4
5. Classroom Management Expectations	5
6. Grading and Reporting Cycle	5
7. Professional Conduct	6
8. Professional Development	6
9. Use of School Resources and Facilities	7
10. Substitute and Leave Procedures	7
11. Performance Review Process	8
12. Frequently Asked Questions	8

1. Welcome and Purpose

This handbook provides ABC School teaching staff with a single reference point for expectations, procedures, and resources relevant to day-to-day teaching responsibilities. It complements, rather than replaces, the individual employment agreement and any subject-specific guidance issued by Grade or Subject Coordinators.

New teachers receive a guided orientation during the first week of employment, during which key sections of this handbook are reviewed in person with the relevant Coordinator.

2. School Mission and Teaching Philosophy

ABC School's teaching philosophy centers on active, student-led learning supported by clear structure and consistent routines. Teachers are encouraged to design lessons that connect concepts to real-world contexts, differentiate for a range of learner needs, and build in regular opportunities for formative feedback.

- Lessons should have a clear, stated learning objective that students can articulate by the end of class.
- Differentiation should be planned proactively, not improvised only when a student struggles.
- Assessment is treated as an ongoing conversation about learning, not solely a final judgment.

3. Roles and Reporting Lines

Role	Reports To	Key Responsibilities
Class Teacher	Grade Coordinator	Daily instruction, attendance, parent communication for their class
Subject Specialist	Subject Coordinator	Subject-specific instruction across multiple classes
Grade Coordinator	Vice Principal (Academics)	Oversight of a grade level's curriculum delivery and pastoral care
Subject Coordinator	Vice Principal (Academics)	Consistency of curriculum and assessment within a subject area
Vice Principal (Academics)	Principal	School-wide academic standards and staff development

4. Working Hours and Duties

Teaching staff are expected on campus from 15 minutes before the start of the school day until 30 minutes after dismissal, in addition to scheduled duties and meetings described below.

Duty Type	Frequency	Notes
Morning Supervision Duty	Rotational, 1-2 mornings per week	Gate or corridor supervision
Lunch Duty	Rotational, 1 day per week	Supervision of lunch and recess areas
Grade-Level Meeting	Weekly	Coordination with Grade Coordinator and peers
Subject Department Meeting	Bi-weekly	Curriculum alignment and assessment moderation
Staff Meeting	Monthly	Whole-school updates and training

5. Classroom Management Expectations

Consistent classroom management supports both learning and student wellbeing. Teachers are expected to establish clear routines within the first two weeks of the school year and to apply behavior expectations consistently and fairly.

- Display and reinforce a simple, positively framed set of classroom expectations.
- Use a graduated, restorative approach to behavior management before escalating to the Grade Coordinator.
- Document recurring behavioral concerns using the school's incident log system rather than relying on memory.
- Communicate minor concerns to parents promptly and constructively, ideally within the same week.

6. Grading and Reporting Cycle

Activity	Frequency	Submission Deadline
Formative Assessment Recording	Ongoing	Within 1 week of each assessment
Progress Check-In Reports	Mid-term	By the Friday of the mid-term week
Term Report Cards	End of each term	1 week before term ends, for review by Coordinator
Grade Moderation Meeting	End of each term	Scheduled by Subject Coordinator

7. Professional Conduct

Teachers are expected to model the values they ask of students: respect, integrity, and professionalism, both within school and in public-facing communication including social media.

- Maintain professional boundaries with students at all times, including in digital communication.
- Treat all student and family information as confidential, sharing only on a need-to-know basis with colleagues directly involved in a student's education.
- Address disagreements with colleagues professionally and, where unresolved, escalate through the appropriate Coordinator rather than in front of students or parents.
- Dress in a manner consistent with the school's professional dress expectations, communicated separately by the Human Resources office.

8. Professional Development

All teaching staff are expected to engage in a minimum of 20 hours of professional development per academic year, a portion of which is provided through school-organized training days, with the remainder available through approved external courses or conferences.

9. Use of School Resources and Facilities

Shared resources such as the library, science laboratories, computer labs, and the multipurpose hall are bookable through the shared facilities calendar managed by the front office. Teachers should book at least 48 hours in advance where possible.

Resource	Booking Lead Time	Notes
Computer Lab	48 hours	Limited to 24 workstations
Science Laboratory	48 hours	Lab technician support available on request
Multipurpose Hall	1 week	Priority given to whole-school events
Library Group Room	24 hours	Suitable for small group instruction

10. Substitute and Leave Procedures

Planned leave should be requested through the Human Resources system at least two weeks in advance where possible. For unplanned absence due to illness, teachers must notify their Grade or Subject Coordinator before 6:30 AM on the day of absence so that substitute coverage can be arranged.

Teachers are asked to maintain an up-to-date set of emergency substitute materials for their classes, covering at least two days of instruction, to support continuity of learning during unplanned absences.

11. Performance Review Process

Stage	Timing	Description
Goal Setting	Start of year	Teacher and Coordinator agree on 2-3 professional goals
Mid-Year Check-In	Mid-year	Informal review of progress against goals
Classroom Observation	Twice per year	Formal observation with structured feedback
End-of-Year Review	End of year	Summary review and goal-setting for following year

12. Frequently Asked Questions

Who do I contact for classroom supplies?

Submit a request through the shared resources form; routine supplies are restocked monthly, with urgent requests handled by the Operations Office within 2 working days.

How do I report a maintenance issue in my classroom?

Log the issue through the Facilities request system; urgent safety issues should also be reported verbally to the front office immediately.

What is the process for requesting a curriculum change?

Propose changes through the relevant Subject Coordinator, who reviews them with the Vice Principal (Academics) ahead of the following term's planning cycle.